Simen Aardal Ulsaker

Associate Professor, Oslo Business School, OsloMet
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Fields of Interest

Industrial organization; applied microeconomics; competition and regulation; retail and grocery markets; vertical relationships and exclusionary contracts.

Employment

Oslo Business School, OsloMet — Oslo, Norway
Associate Professor — 2024 – present

Norwegian School of Economics (NHH) — Bergen, Norway
Adjunct Associate Professor, Department of Economics — 2020 – present
Assistant Professor — 2016 – 2020

Oslo Economics — Oslo, Norway
Manager — 2023 – 2024

Telenor Research — Bærum, Norway
Senior Research Scientist — 2020 – 2023

Education

Norwegian School of Economics (NHH) — Bergen, Norway
PhD in Economics — 2012 – 2016

Toulouse School of Economics (TSE) — Toulouse, France
Visiting PhD student — January – December 2014

University of Bergen — Bergen, Norway
MSc in Economics — 2010 – 2012
MA in Philosophy — 2008 – 2010
BA in Philosophy & Economics — 2005 – 2007

Research

Publications

- Exclusionary Contracts and Incentives to Innovate. *Games*, 17(1), 8, 2026.
- Cross-border Shopping of Alcohol – What is the Effect on Tax Revenue and Sales and Which Products Are Most Affected? (Joint with Richard Friberg and Frode Steen.) *Review of International Economics*, 33(5), 2025, pp. 1021–1034.
- The effect of cross-border shopping on commodity tax revenue: Results from Norway's COVID-19 border closings. (Joint with Richard Friberg, Emil Halseth and Frode Steen.) *Scandinavian Journal of Economics*, 126(4), 2024. Awarded the journal's prize for the best article published in 2024.
- Co-location, good, bad or both: How does new entry of discount variety store affect local grocery business? (Joint with Charlotte B. Evensen and Frode Steen.) *Journal of the European Economic Association*, 22(4), 2024, pp. 1798–1843.
- Competition and risk taking in local bank markets: Evidence from the business loans segment. (Joint with Chiara Canta and Øivind Anti Nilsen.) *Journal of Empirical Finance*, 73, 2023, pp. 153–169.
- Hump-shaped cross-price effects and the extensive margin in cross-border shopping. (Joint with Richard Friberg and Frode Steen.) *American Economic Journal: Microeconomics*, 14(2), 2022, pp. 408–438.

- Bank consolidation, interest rates, and risk: A post-merger analysis based on loan-level data from the corporate sector. (Joint with Steffen Juranek and Øivind Anti Nilsen.) *Journal of Competition Law & Economics*, 18(4), 2022, pp. 771–794.
- Lump-sum payments and retail services: A relational contracting perspective. (Joint with Teis L. Lømo.) *Journal of Industrial Economics*, 69, 2021, pp. 131–168.
- Competing buyers, rent extraction and inefficient exclusion. *International Journal of Industrial Organization*, 68, 2020.
- Upstream merger in a successive oligopoly: Who pays the price? (Joint with Øivind Anti Nilsen and Lars Sørgard.) *International Journal of Industrial Organization*, 48, 2016, pp. 143–172.
- Interlocking relationships and quantity rationing. *Economics Letters*, 146, 2016, pp. 47–49.
- Menu contracts and the division of profits in vertical relationships. *Economics Letters*, 138, 2016, pp. 72–74.

Working Papers and Work in Progress

- Unemployment shocks, cyclical prices and shopping behavior. (Joint with Thor Andreas Aursland, Richard Friberg and Frode Steen.) Revise and resubmit.
- Do Informed Consumers Pay Less? Evidence from a Survey with Linked Grocery Purchase Data. (Joint with Richard Friberg, Emil Halseth and Frode Steen.)
- Climate-Impact Knowledge and Consumer Behavior: Evidence from a Randomized Information Experiment Linked to Scanner Data. (Joint with David Bilén, Mathias Ekström and Frode Steen.)
- Exclusionary contracts and investment. (Joint with Greg Shaffer.)

Peer-reviewed Publications in Norwegian

- Annerledeslandet Norge: butikktilgjengelighet og markedskonsentrasjon i Sverige og Norge. (Joint with Richard Friberg, Ivar Pettersen and Frode Steen.) Book chapter in *Mot bedre vitende i norsk matsektor* (ed. Frode Steen and Ivar Pettersen), 2020, pp. 35–70.
- Produktivitetsutvikling i norsk matsektor. (Joint with Ivar Pettersen and Frode Steen.) Book chapter in *Mot bedre vitende i norsk matsektor* (ed. Frode Steen and Ivar Pettersen), 2020, pp. 71–123.
- "Sukkeravgiften" skal øke statens inntekter og redusere sukkerforbruket – men virker den? (Joint with Frode Steen.) *Praktisk økonomi & finans*, 35(1), 2019, pp. 69–84.

Publications in Other Fields

- Conversation logs as a source of insight: Predicting user satisfaction for customer service chatbots. (Joint with F. C. Ay, E. Freddi, A. Følstad, S. Hodnebrog, K. Kvale and O. A. Sell.) *Quality and User Experience*, 10(1), 2025.
- Understanding the difference between office presence and co-presence in team member interactions. (Joint with Nils Brede Moe, Darja Smite, Jarle Moss Hildrum and Fehime Ceren Ay.) *57th Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences (HICSS)*, 2024.
- A method for validation of socio-economic impact from connectivity solutions in rural communities. (Joint with Per J. Nesse and Rick Gilsing.) *2024 IEEE International Conference on Engineering, Technology, and Innovation (ICE/ITMC)*, 2024.

Op-eds

- Pris og prisvekst: Myte at noe er «galt» med prisene i Norge. (Joint with Richard Friberg and Frode Steen.) *Bergens Tidende*, 27 November 2025.
- Hjemmekontor er blitt en rettighet. Det reiser fem viktige spørsmål. (Joint with Jarle Hildrum and Nils Brede Moe.) *Dagens Næringsliv*, 10 October 2022.
- Svenskehandelen vil fortsette på tross av billigere alkohol, brus og snus. (Joint with Richard Friberg and Frode Steen.) *Dagens Næringsliv*, 7 December 2020.
- Finnes det ekte lavprisbutikker i Norge? (Joint with Frode Steen.) *Bergens Tidende*, 31 March 2019.
- Mindre sukker svir, men hvor mye og for hvem? (Joint with Frode Steen.) *VG*, 6 April 2018.
- Trenger norske konsumenter et bedre vern mot importvernet? (Joint with Ivar Pettersen and Frode Steen.) *Dagbladet*, 19 January 2018.
- Mat på nett uten oppskrift. (Joint with Frode Steen.) *Dagens Næringsliv*, 23 September 2017.

Selected Seminar and Conference Presentations

2021 EEA (Copenhagen), INRAE (Paris), BI (Oslo).

2016 Swedish Competition Authority.

2015 EARIE (Munich), BECCLE (Bergen), CLEEN (Tilburg), CREST (Paris).

2014 EARIE (Milan), CLEEN (Norwich), IO: Theory, Empirics and Experiments (Alberobello).

2013 EARIE (Evora), CRESSE (Corfu), CLEEN (Bergen), Nordic Econometric Meeting (Bergen), Annual Meeting of the Norwegian Association of Economists (Oslo).

Teaching

Course Responsibility

Oslo Business School, OsloMet

Næringsøkonomi (Industrial Organization)	Spring 2025, 2026
Microeconomics (master), with Jacopo Bizzotto	Fall 2024, 2025, 2026
Microeconomics II (bachelor), with Jacopo Bizzotto	Fall 2024, 2025
Game Theory, with Jacopo Bizzotto	Fall 2026

Norwegian School of Economics

Retail Analytics, with Frode Steen and Richard Friberg	Spring 2021, 2022, 2025
Competitive Strategy, with Sissel Jensen	Spring 2019, 2020
Firm Strategy and Competition	Fall 2017, 2018
Applied Data Analysis for Firm Strategy and Competition, with Morten Sæthre	Spring 2017, 2018

Teaching Assistantships

Norwegian School of Economics

Konkurranseanalyse (Competition Analysis)	Fall 2015, 2016
Næringsøkonomi (Industrial Organization)	Spring 2015, 2016
Applied Data Analysis for Firm Strategy and Competition	Spring 2016
Konkurranserett (Competition Law)	Fall 2012, 2013
Næringsøkonomi (Industrial Organization)	Spring 2013

University of Bergen

Velferdsstatens økonomi (Economics of the Welfare State)	Fall 2011
Politisk økonomi (Political Economy)	Spring 2011

Academic Citizenship

Oslo Business School, OsloMet

Coordinator, bachelor's programme in Økonomi og administrasjon (ØKAD)	2025 – present

Norwegian School of Economics (NHH)

Board member, Department of Economics	2018 – 2019
Deputy board member	2018 – 2019

Bergen Center for Competition Law and Economics (BECCLE)

Member of leadership group	2017 – 2020
Member of Scientific Committee, BECCLE conference	2019 – 2020

Referee Assignments

European Economic Review ($\times$2), International Economic Review, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, Journal of Health Economics, Journal of Industrial Economics, International Journal of Industrial Organization ($\times$2), Review of Industrial Organization, Scandinavian Journal of Economics ($\times$2).